

A GLOBAL OVERVIEW

India



RAFALE
FIGHTER JET

\$115-124 mn



TEJAS MK1A
FIGHTER JET

\$42 mn



MQ-9B
SKYGUARDIAN
DRONE

\$129 mn



HERON MKII
(ISRAELI ORIGIN)
DRONE

\$5-10 mn



RUSTOM-II
DRONE

\$1-2 mn

China



J-20
FIGHTER JET

\$110-120 mn



J-10CE
(WITH PAKISTAN)
FIGHTER JET

\$25-30 mn

(Block I-III)



FEILONG-3000 D
DRONE

\$10,000

Pakistan



JF-17 THUNDER
(WITH CHINA)
FIGHTER JET

\$25-30 mn

(Block I-III)



F-16
(US ORIGIN)
FIGHTER JET

\$40-70 mn



WING LOONG II
(WITH CHINA)
DRONE

\$1-2 mn



BAYRAKTAR TB2
(TURKEY ORIGIN)
DRONE

\$10-20 mn



CH-4
(WITH CHINA)
DRONE

\$4-8 mn



BURRAQ
(INDIGENOUS)
DRONE

<\$1 mn

NOTE FIGURES REPRESENT UNIT COSTS OF RESPECTIVE COUNTRIES

lar spent (Bang for Buck). It is measured across a full mission profile, including survivability, reusability, flexibility, and escalation management,” says Air Marshal Khosla.

Maximising deterrence for the dollar spent is the biggest challenge facing the Indian armed forces now. It is difficult for India to match China and Pakistan on every platform. The paradox for defence planners trying to build sustainable deterrence is not just military but also economic.

Deterrence, in simple parlance, is a demand that another state refrain from doing something. For that,

India needs to bring its National Strategic Policy to communicate its objectives vis-à-vis its two adversaries unambiguously.

India needs to build its military might through conventional capabilities such as stealth fighter jets and air defence systems, with lower-cost force multipliers like drones, cyber capabilities, and AI-enabled systems.

A National Strategic Policy will also help the Indian domestic industry focus on its stated military goals rather than doing emergency procurements during a crisis. Self-reliance in defence is a good be-